



Python Software Foundation Strategic Plan 2026

DRAFT for Community Feedback, based on the PSF Board's strategic planning and PSF staff feedback

About This Document

This document shares the crosscutting organizational goals and program goals the Python Software Foundation (PSF) Board developed during a strategic planning process that began at the 2024 board retreat, continued with community interviews in 2025, and concluded with board planning sessions in early 2026. It is being published for community feedback alongside a blog post that provides additional context, including the feedback we received at PyCon US 2026.

The PSF Board aims to adopt the plan in a future board meeting after integrating community feedback. The plan covers a five-year period and will be reviewed annually with community input.

How to Provide Feedback

The PSF is sharing this document in its formative stages because transparency and collaboration are important to us. The Python community has deep expertise across every area this plan touches, and we want that expertise to shape the result.

Feedback is especially welcome on the objectives under each program goal: are they the right ones, and is anything important missing?

It is helpful to distinguish between two kinds of feedback:

- 1. Feedback on the strategic direction.** Are these the right goals? Are the objectives the right ones? Is anything important missing? This is what we most need help with, and it will directly shape this document.
- 2. Implementation insights.** Practical considerations, capacity realities, and connections between goals that could be strengthened. These won't necessarily change the document, but they will inform how the PSF carries out the plan.

For this feedback round, we ask you to focus on the strategic direction rather than implementation details. Are these the right goals? Are the objectives the right ones? Is anything important missing? How to carry out the plan is the job of PSF staff, and there will be opportunities to weigh in on implementation over time.

How to share your feedback:

- Email strategy@python.org for detailed or private feedback
- Join the conversation on [Discuss](#)
- Attend the PSF Board Office Hours on June 9 or June 23, on the PSF Discord
- [PSF Board Office Hours](#) on the [PSF Discord](#) on:
 - [June 9, 2026, 9 PM UTC](#)
 - [June 23, 2026, 1 PM UTC](#)

The feedback window closes on [June 25, 2026, End of Day, Anywhere on Earth](#).

Context

The five-year strategy is pending annual review, with the opportunity for change at each review point.

As part of the strategic planning process, the PSF Board conducted numerous interviews with PSF staff, community members, and participants across the Python ecosystem. Following the interviews, the board went through a prioritization exercise, in-person discussions during board offsites, and a series of dedicated and structured board discussions. Three foundational themes emerged from this process and were reinforced throughout. Every goal in this plan should be read through these lenses:

Staffing is the binding constraint. The PSF's ability to do more is constrained by the number of staff and the time they have. For example, we cannot do more fundraising without more staffing, we don't have the staff time to overhaul PyCon US, and expanding any program area requires an honest assessment of capacity.

PyCon US is not currently profitable. Current conference revenues aren't covering expenses, suggesting a need to optimize our investment. At the same time, PyCon US remains the backbone of sponsor relationships. This tension must be addressed directly, not merely monitored.

Some sponsors want to give more. Interviews revealed that some sponsors may want to give the PSF more if given more opportunities. This is a potential untapped resource that requires deliberate cultivation.



Crosscutting Organizational Goals

These goals apply across all PSF activities and programs. They represent how we operate, not what we deliver.

A note on the tactic ideas below. Each organizational goal is followed by a short summary of tactical ideas the board developed during the planning process. These are suggestions and starting points, not commitments. How to implement them is for PSF staff to shape. Feedback on these ideas is welcome, but please treat them as the beginning of a conversation.

1. Financial Sustainability

Build a diversified financial foundation that reduces dependency on any single revenue source and supports the PSF's mission for decades to come.

Ideas raised by the board in this area include addressing the current PyCon US profitability gap as an active intervention rather than a monitoring exercise; diversifying revenue beyond conferences through grantor fundraising, services for PyPI users, and corporate partnerships; strengthening the message that regional associations should lead local events, supporting their journey toward financial independence from PSF grants; expanding the Developer-in-Residence model and exploring additional "in residence" roles for critical functions; and working toward financial reserves to buffer against revenue volatility, including evaluating whether an endowment model could support long-term sustainability.

2. Building a Resilient Foundation

Strengthen internal governance, financial oversight, and knowledge management so the organization can operate transparently and sustain continuity through transitions.

Ideas raised by the board in this area include strengthening internal governance structures; enhancing financial oversight, reporting, and budget management; developing documentation and digital systems that preserve institutional knowledge (and possibly making some of that information public for other communities to learn from); upgrading email to a service desk system to distribute the communication load; defining a clearer process for launching new initiatives while being careful not to gatekeep activities that don't need PSF approval; restructuring workgroups to be more efficient and outcome-focused; and investing in succession planning and cross-training to reduce knowledge silos.



3. Diversity and Inclusion

The board was explicit: D&I is not a separate program. It is a lens applied to all decisions and activities.

Rather than a list of tactics, the board's direction here is that diversity and inclusion should be embedded in the execution of every PSF activity, program, and operation and applied as a critical evaluation criterion for organizational decisions. Diverse representation in staff, leadership, speakers, grant recipients, and participants matters across all programs. The board also noted that a good beginner story (covered under Program Goal 4) directly contributes to diversity.

4. Transparency and Community Trust

The PSF's credibility as the "voice of Python" depends on the community trusting its governance and decision-making.

Ideas raised by the board in this area include enhancing day-to-day operational transparency and continuity of communication during transitions; improving the quality, frequency, and accessibility of public reporting; increasing community visibility into board decisions, financial allocation, and strategic planning; continuing and expanding PSF Office Hours as a community dialogue mechanism; and strengthening relationships with the tech press for more earned media coverage.

5. Community Empowerment and Self-Sufficiency

Design programs that build community capacity for self-organization rather than ongoing PSF reliance. Enable, don't direct. Empower, share, and collaborate between equals.

Ideas raised by the board in this area include providing funding guidance, templates, and grassroots fundraising support; creating toolkits that help communities secure their own funding (since many companies will support local events but would not support PSF directly); supporting regional Python associations in developing their own governance and fundraising capacity evaluating a reopening of the fiscal sponsorship program as a service to the community once organizational capacity allows; designing programs that build self-organization rather than dependency; investing in local leadership development; and facilitating peer-to-peer networks between Python communities globally.



6. Strong Partnerships and Collaboration

The PSF needs a deliberate partnership strategy with organizations that distribute, extend, and depend on Python, as well as with community groups across the Python and Open Source ecosystems.

Ideas raised by the board in this area include building collaborative relationships with distribution partners who control how most people get Python, rather than just acknowledging that they exist; developing a framework for engaging constructively with companies that depend on and contribute to Python in different ways to advance shared interests; cultivating sponsor relationships, since some sponsors may want to give more if given more opportunities, which is an untapped resource; partnering with regional and affinity groups to foster a distributed rather than a centralized community best able to serve the needs of all its subsets; and collaborating across the broader Open Source ecosystem to foster the exchange of ideas and cross-organizational learning as well as to flex communal power and influence on shared issues across Open Source communities.



Program Goals

These are the four program goals selected through a board prioritization exercise. The objectives listed under each program goal reflect the board's agreed direction. Community feedback on these is welcome, particularly on completeness, framing, and whether anything important is missing.

1. Secure Python's Software Supply Chain and Distribution Infrastructure

PyPI is critical global infrastructure. If it goes down, companies cannot deploy. Supply chain security is not just about the index; it encompasses the entire chain from source to installation. Meanwhile, most Python distribution happens outside PSF control, which creates both security risks and partnership needs.

Objectives:

- **PyPI Security:** Continue to maintain and expand PyPI's position as an industry standard for secure software supply chain. Enhance PyPI operations and implement security measures to protect the package ecosystem. Invest in PyPI revenue generation.
- **Supply Chain Protection:** Strengthen protocols and monitoring to defend against vulnerabilities throughout the software supply chain.
- **Distribution Channels:** Ensure Python is distributed through verified, secure channels. Develop a partnership strategy with major distributors (Debian, uv, Anaconda, Microsoft) that the PSF does not control.
- **Python Security:** Support advancing security protocols and practices for CPython development and releases with the Python Core Team.
- **Security Baseline:** Bolster security for all PSF projects and services.

2. Responsibly Grow and Advance Critical Python Infrastructure

The PSF stewards the infrastructure that the entire Python ecosystem depends on. Growth must be responsible, matched to staffing capacity, and sustainable funding models.

Objectives:

- **PyPI Growth and Reliability:** Scale and improve PyPI to meet growing global demand while maintaining high performance and uptime.
- **CPython Development:** Provide sustained support through the Developer-in-Residence program. Three sponsored developers is a proven model with the potential to expand. Build on accountability and transparency toward the community.
- **Vulnerability Management:** Address the rapid growth in security vulnerability reports across PSF projects, ensuring the capacity to triage and respond effectively.



- **Python.org Enhancement:** Modernize and expand python.org to better serve as the gateway for newcomers and the community's primary information source.
- **Packaging Tooling:** Invest in Python's packaging tools to enhance capabilities, performance, and user experience.
- **Intellectual Property Defense:** Protect Python's trademarks, copyrights, and other IP rights.
- **Core Infrastructure Scaling:** Maintain and grow other essential infrastructure to support the expanding Python ecosystem.

3. Foster a Thriving, Connected Global Python Community

The PSF connects the global Python community through events, grants, and working groups. The challenge is doing this sustainably while empowering regional self-sufficiency rather than creating dependency.

Objectives:

- **PyCon US:** Sustain PyCon US as a mission-driven flagship event with a stable, predictable cost structure that does not expose the PSF to financial risk. Address the profitability concern while maintaining its status. Consider distributing key elements (the Language Summit going to EuroPython is a good precedent). Factor in travel and visa barriers affecting international attendance. Consider how to better serve the international community while continuing to excellently serve PyCon US' domestic audience.
- **Grants Program Reform:** Move from opportunistic, first-come-first-serve to strategic grant-making. Fund different types of initiatives, including education. Improve report evaluation and communication. Help communities learn grassroots fundraising.
- **Workgroups:** Review and revisit current workgroup models to ensure they can operate efficiently and sustainably without over-relying on PSF staff capacity.
- **International Collaboration:** Facilitate gatherings and collaboration across global Python communities. The PSF's role is to enable and share, not to organize directly.
- **Inclusive Outreach:** Intentionally welcome and engage Python users who don't yet think of themselves as "Python Community Members."

4. Develop the Next Generation of Python Developers

This goal connects the PSF's public advocacy role with making Python accessible to newcomers. The PSF has already done significant work here (CRA advocacy, security leadership, writings on running a massive repository), which directly affects fundraising ability and partnerships.



Objectives:

- **Voice of Python:** Establish and amplify the PSF as the trusted voice representing Python and its community to the wider world. Build on existing advocacy and policy work.
- **Accessibility Initiatives:** Remove barriers and make Python more accessible to newcomers, underrepresented groups, and diverse learners.
- **Beginner's Journey:** Establish comprehensive pathways on python.org that guide new developers from first steps to proficiency.
- **Community Storytelling:** Share compelling narratives that showcase Python's impact and inspire new developers to join the community (e.g., a "Python documentary").
- **Outreach Resources:** Develop and distribute promotional materials, guides, and tools that support community growth and engagement.

Thank You

Thank you for taking the time to review this draft. The PSF Board developed this plan through interviews, prioritization exercises, and structured discussion. We know that each individual in the Python community has perspectives and expertise that can improve it. Your feedback will directly shape the final plan.

Jannis Leidel, PSF Board Chair, on behalf of the PSF Board of Directors